Seth Strickland

strickland@cmu.edu · +1 607 288 2604 · Pittsburgh, PA
linkedin.com/in/sethjstrickland · buzzcauldron.github.io · github.com/buzzcauldron

Profile

Academic operations specialist with a PhD and a track record of building and running forums, lecture series, and cross-unit programs—from co-founding *Public Works* and chairing *Issuing Citations* to department-level graduate administration. Trusted partner to leadership on recruitment, handbook and RPT processes, program launches, and organizational assessment; combines scheduling and stakeholder coordination with clear public-facing communication.

Core Competencies

Graduate Recruitment & Admissions • Retention, Promotion & Tenure (RPT) Support • Handbook & Policy Review • Program & Certificate Launch • Academic Affairs Assessment • Staffing & Adjunct-Appointment Planning • Graduate Data Review • Forum & Lecture-Series Organization • Cross-Disciplinary Program Coordination • Stakeholder & Event Management • Grant & Program Proposals • Public-Facing Communications • Workday-Ready Documentation • LaTeX, Markdown, Excel

Experience

Academic and Administrative Operations Advisor **Oct – Dec 2026**
Carnegie Mellon University, Department of English, Pittsburgh, PA

- Extension of part-time special faculty appointment (∼10–15 hrs/week), reporting to the Department Head; supported English graduate program operations alongside a continuing Lecturer role.
- Led graduate recruitment: campaign planning, applicant follow-up, and review of Dietrich College graduate applications; refined public-facing graduate recruitment FAQs.
- Coordinated PhD certificate launch with staff and faculty; collaborated on graduate handbook revisions and RPT processes; conducted graduate student data review.
- Assessed departmental administrative structure for academic affairs, staff duty assignments, and part-time adjunct appointment needs.

Graduate Advisor **Sep – Oct 2026**
Carnegie Mellon University, Department of English, Pittsburgh, PA

- Part-time special faculty appointment (∼10 hrs/week): graduate recruitment and Dietrich application review; AI-assisted grad recruitment FAQs; PhD certificate coordination; handbook and RPT support; graduate data review.

Chair & Co-Founder **2025 – Present**
Issuing Citations, Pittsburgh, PA

- Established and sustain a recurring meeting space where graduate students present work-in-progress to peers from other disciplines—handling outreach, scheduling, format, and facilitation each session.
- Built cross-departmental participation so presenters receive feedback outside their home fields; maintain continuity of programming term to term.

Co-Founder & Organizer **2022 – 2023**
Public Works, Ithaca, NY

- Co-founded and ran an interdisciplinary public lecture series connecting academic speakers with general audiences (publicworks.info).
- Managed speaker recruitment, event logistics, publicity, and editorial shaping of talks for non-specialist audiences.

Lecturer, Writing & Communication **2023 – Present**
Carnegie Mellon University, Pittsburgh, PA

- Design and deliver writing and communication courses for interdisciplinary undergraduates; develop reusable curricular materials and student-facing guides at scale (50+ students per term).
- Member, Diversity, Equity, and Inclusion Working Group, Department of English.
- Provost's Inclusive Teaching Fellow.

Founder & Coordinator **2025 – 2026**
Computational Humanities Initiatives, CMU, Pittsburgh, PA

- Founded and ran cross-departmental research programming—including a series that became a required graduate seminar—in partnership with the Posner Center and CMU Libraries.
- Managed event logistics, scheduling, and multi-unit stakeholder communication.

Program Collaborator **AY 2026–27**
Beatrice Institute, Pittsburgh, PA

- Co-proposed an eight-event undergraduate series; secured a $20,000 Collegiate Cultural Foundation grant (awarded without revision) with three co-proposers.
- Seminar leader for a seven-session undergraduate series on courtship, dating, and marriage.

Graduate Leadership & Instruction (earlier) **2014 – 2023**
Cornell University & Saint Louis University, Ithaca, NY / St. Louis, MO

- President, Medieval Studies Graduate Organization; Graduate Policy and Liaison Committee member (Cornell).
- EGSO event planner and treasurer; Graduate Student Association representative for English (Saint Louis University).
- Instructor of Record and Martino Lecturer across writing and literature courses.

Education

PhD, Medieval Literature — Cornell University 2022

MA, English — Saint Louis University 2016

BA, Classics & English Literature — Hillsdale College 2012